



## External Vendor Management Module

### Key Features

#### 1. Vendor Registration and Management

- **Vendor Onboarding:** Allow clients to add new vendors with relevant details.
- **Vendor Information:** Store and manage vendor contact details, contract terms, and other critical information.
- **Vendor Categories:** Categorize vendors for better organization and reporting.

#### 2. Purchase Orders and Vendor Invoices

- **Create Purchase Orders:** Generate and manage purchase orders for vendors.
- **Vendor Invoice Management:** Record and track invoices received from vendors.
- **Recurring Orders:** Set up and manage recurring purchase orders.

#### 3. Payment Management

- **Payment Tracking:** Track payments made to vendors.
- **Payment Schedules:** Schedule payments based on invoice due dates.
- **Vendor Statements:** Generate statements showing all transactions with a vendor.

#### 4. Communication and Collaboration

- **Vendor Portal:** Provide vendors with access to a portal where they can view their purchase orders, invoices, and payment status.
- **Document Sharing:** Allow clients to share documents and contracts with vendors.
- **Messaging System:** Enable direct communication between clients and vendors within the application.

#### 5. Vendor Performance Tracking

- **Performance Metrics:** Track vendor performance based on delivery times, product/service quality, and adherence to contract terms.
- **Feedback and Ratings:** Allow clients to rate and provide feedback on vendor performance.
- **Dispute Management:** Track and manage disputes with vendors.

#### 6. Reporting and Analytics

- **Vendor Reports:** Generate reports on vendor performance, payments, and outstanding invoices.
- **Customizable Dashboards:** Provide dashboards for monitoring vendor activities and performance metrics.
- **Export Data:** Export vendor-related data in various formats (PDF, Excel, CSV).

### Detailed Breakdown of Each Feature

#### 1. Vendor Registration and Management



- **Vendor Onboarding:**
  - **Form Fields:** Vendor name, contact person, address, phone number, email, contract terms, categories.
  - **Approval Workflow:** Set up an approval process for adding new vendors.
  - **Document Upload:** Allow clients to upload and attach relevant documents (contracts, agreements).
- **Vendor Information:**
  - **Central Repository:** Store all vendor information in a central repository.
  - **Editable Profiles:** Allow clients to update vendor details as needed.
  - **Search and Filter:** Enable searching and filtering vendors by various criteria (name, category, status).
- **Vendor Categories:**
  - **Category Management:** Create and manage vendor categories for better organization.
  - **Multiple Categories:** Assign vendors to multiple categories if needed.

## 2. Purchase Orders and Vendor Invoices

- **Create Purchase Orders:**
  - **PO Form:** Include fields for vendor selection, item details, quantities, prices, delivery dates.
  - **PO Templates:** Provide templates for standard purchase orders.
  - **Approval Workflow:** Set up an approval process for purchase orders.
- **Vendor Invoice Management:**
  - **Invoice Recording:** Record invoices received from vendors with details (invoice number, date, amount, due date).
  - **Invoice Matching:** Match invoices with corresponding purchase orders.
  - **Recurring Orders:** Set up recurring orders for regular purchases from vendors.

## 3. Payment Management

- **Payment Tracking:**
  - **Payment Records:** Record payments made to vendors, including dates, amounts, and payment methods.
  - **Payment Status:** Track the status of payments (pending, completed, overdue).
- **Payment Schedules:**
  - **Due Dates:** Automatically calculate payment due dates based on invoice terms.
  - **Reminders:** Send reminders for upcoming payments.
- **Vendor Statements:**
  - **Transaction History:** Generate statements showing all transactions with a vendor over a specified period.
  - **Balance Summary:** Display outstanding balances and payments made.



#### 4. Communication and Collaboration

- **Vendor Portal:**
  - **Portal Access:** Provide vendors with access to a portal where they can log in and view their details.
  - **View Documents:** Allow vendors to view purchase orders, invoices, and payment status.
  - **Update Information:** Enable vendors to update their contact details and preferences.
- **Document Sharing:**
  - **Document Upload:** Allow clients to share documents such as contracts, agreements, and specifications with vendors.
  - **Access Control:** Set permissions for vendors to view, download, or upload documents.
- **Messaging System:**
  - **Direct Messaging:** Enable direct communication between clients and vendors.
  - **Message History:** Maintain a history of communications for reference.

#### 5. Vendor Performance Tracking

- **Performance Metrics:**
  - **Metrics Tracking:** Track key performance indicators (KPIs) such as delivery times, quality ratings, adherence to terms.
  - **Dashboard View:** Display performance metrics on a dashboard for quick insights.
- **Feedback and Ratings:**
  - **Rating System:** Allow clients to rate vendors on various criteria.
  - **Feedback Forms:** Enable clients to provide detailed feedback on vendor performance.
- **Dispute Management:**
  - **Dispute Records:** Record and manage disputes with vendors, including details and resolution status.
  - **Escalation Process:** Set up an escalation process for unresolved disputes.

#### 6. Reporting and Analytics

- **Vendor Reports:**
  - **Standard Reports:** Generate standard reports on vendor performance, payments, outstanding invoices.
  - **Custom Reports:** Allow clients to create custom reports based on specific criteria.
- **Customizable Dashboards:**
  - **Dashboard Widgets:** Provide widgets for displaying key vendor metrics.
  - **Customization Options:** Allow clients to customize their dashboards to display relevant vendor information.



- **Export Data:**
  - **Export Formats:** Export vendor-related data in PDF, Excel, CSV formats for external analysis and reporting.

## Summary of Benefits

- **Enhanced Vendor Management:** Streamlined processes for adding, managing, and communicating with vendors.
- **Improved Financial Tracking:** Better tracking of purchase orders, invoices, and payments.
- **Performance Monitoring:** Ability to monitor and evaluate vendor performance.
- **Efficient Collaboration:** Improved communication and document sharing capabilities with vendors.
- **Comprehensive Reporting:** Detailed insights into vendor activities and performance through robust reporting and analytics.

## Implementation Considerations

- **User Interface:** Design an intuitive and user-friendly interface for both clients and vendors.
- **Security:** Implement robust security measures to protect sensitive vendor information.
- **Scalability:** Ensure the system can handle a large number of vendors and transactions.
- **Integration:** Integrate the vendor management module with existing modules (e.g., invoicing, payments) for seamless operation.